they relieve pain. The concept 'analgesic' is a humanly constructed one because pain relief is a matter of interest to us.

See ***Adhyavasaya***, ***Kalpana***

Further reading: Kajiyama 1998; Matilal 1986; Siderits 1991 and 2003; Stcherbatsky 1993; Tillemans 1999

Artha: like the English word 'meaning', this is an ambiguous term. Either it may be an object in the world that is the referent of a linguistic expression (the thing meant) or it may be the meaning (the sense) of a word, sentence or context. It also stands for the overall import of a body of literature such as a group of scriptures or some systematic teaching (*shastra*). It may mean purpose or goal. It may also mean property, wealth and possessions (one's *things*). Failure to attend to the word's equivocal nature sometimes leads to mistakes in translation. Sometimes *vishaya* is used for mental content or representation (or the object-as-cognised) and *artha* for the object external to the mind. But there is no hard and fast rule here.

There are different views about what is the *artha* (meaning and thing meant) of a word. The grammarians say that in normal language a noun refers to an individual object (***dravya***, ***vyakti***) by convention. The ***Purva-Mimamsaka*** tradition, which explains the texts dealing with rituals, holds that a noun primarily refers to a class or entities (***jati***) or to the shape or form (***akriti***) that they have in common. The relation between word and meaning is innate and eternal. Words have to be used in sentences if they are to refer to individuals. The ***Nyaya-Vaisheshikas*** say that a word refers to an individual qualified by a class property. Reference and the word meaning relation is a human convention

See ***Lakshana-artha***

Further reading: Ganeri 1999; Kahrs 1998